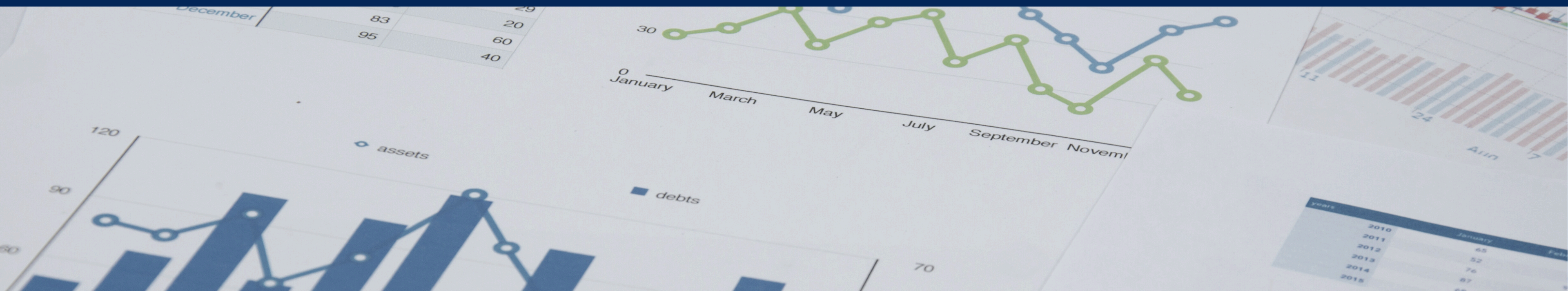


ATHLETICS PERFORMANCE ANALYTICS

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Breanna Hardy, Nawal Choudhry



RESEARCH QUESTION & PURPOSE

Research Question:

How do force-plate and GPS metrics change over time, and can they identify fatigue or abnormal workload?

Purpose:

Analyze metrics over time to support athlete readiness and training decisions.



- Inconsistent monitoring of mechanical load
- Highlights the need for standardized multi-system data collection
- Monitoring fatigue, workload, & performance readiness

WHY THIS MATTERS

Selected Metrics & Why

Hawkins Force Plate:

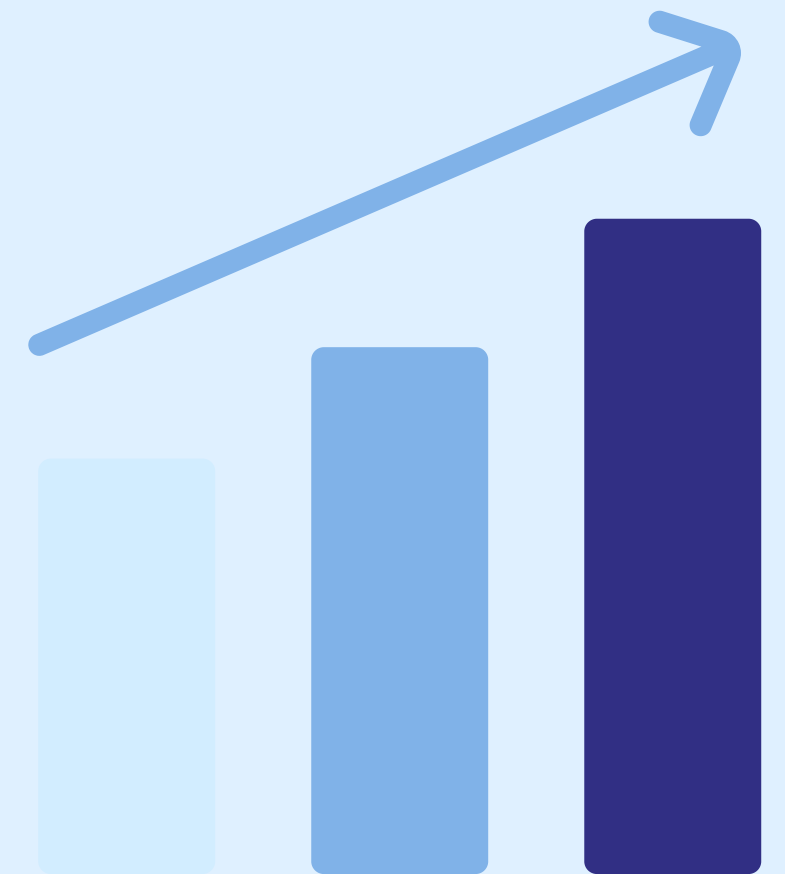
- Jump Height
- RSI
- Peak Propulsive Force

Kinexon GPS:

- Accumulated Acceleration Load
- Total Distance

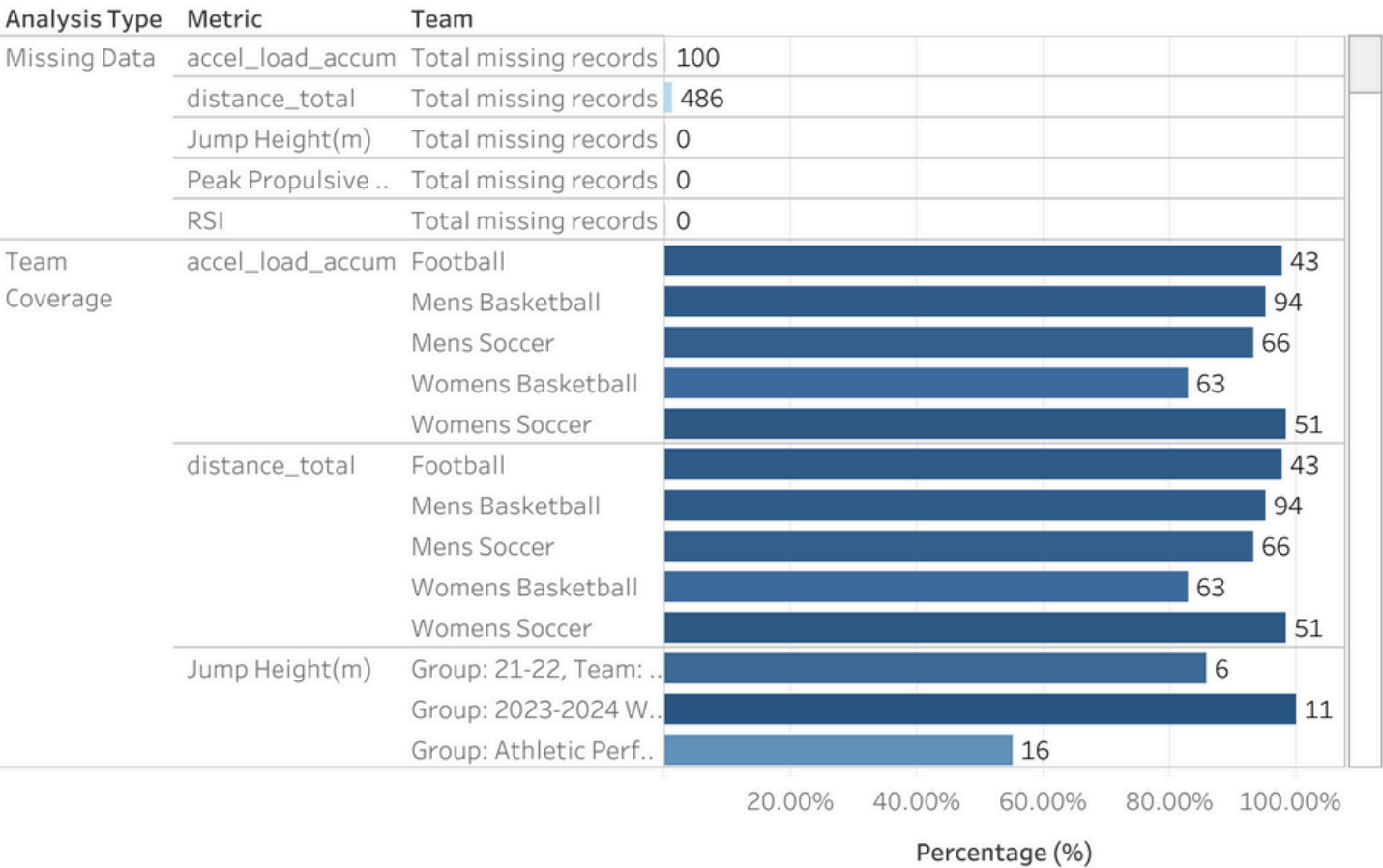
Why These Metrics?

- Capture neuromuscular readiness + mechanical load

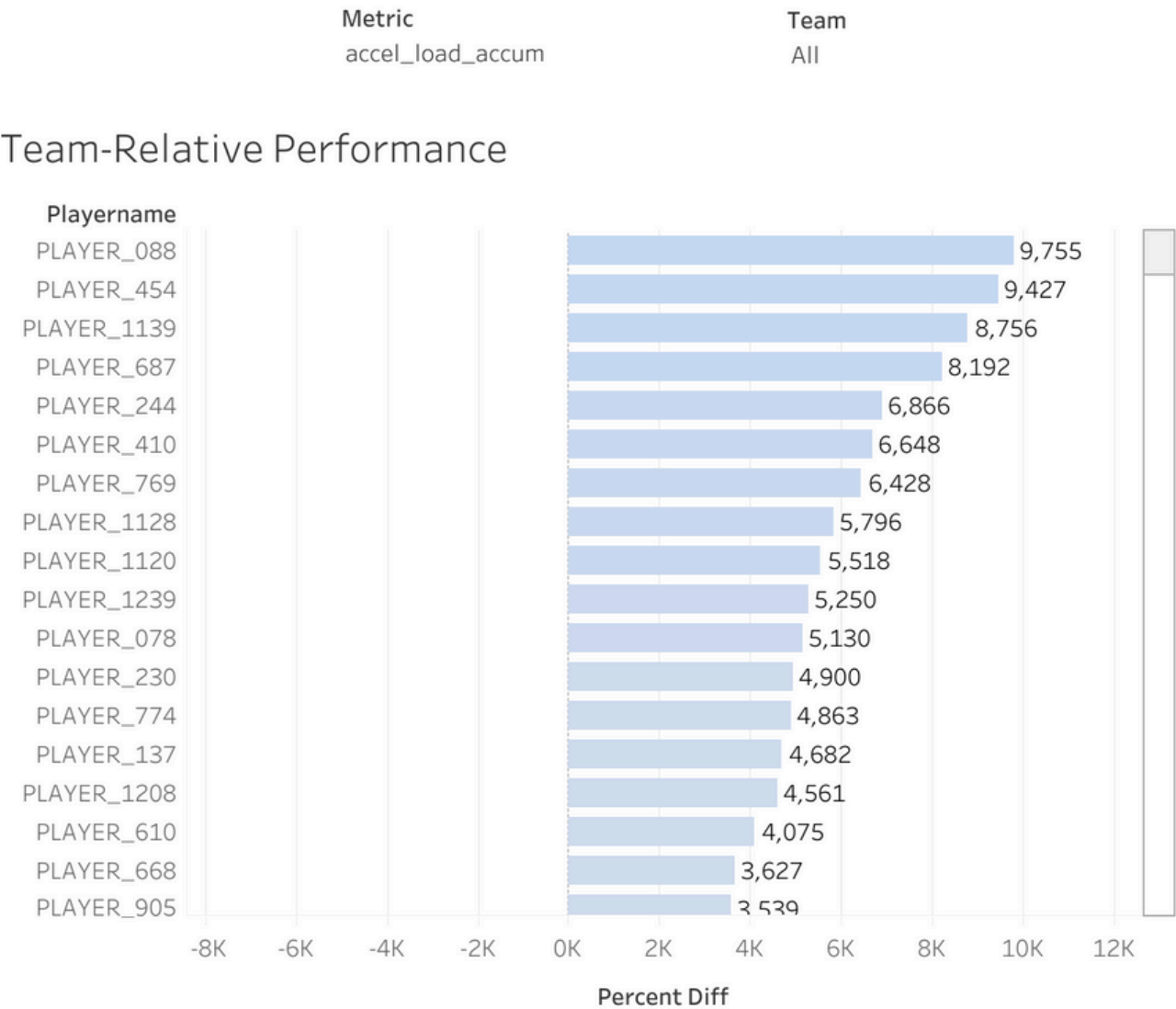


DASHBOARD

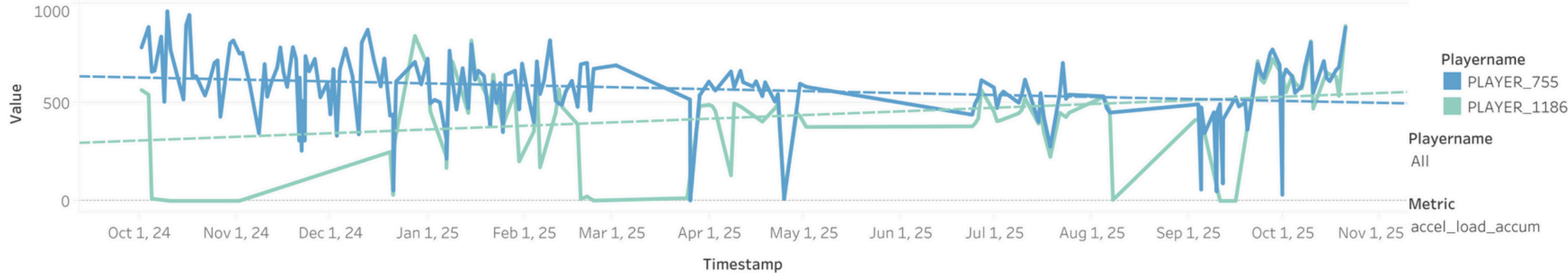
Data Quality



Team-Relative Performance



Two-Athlete Performance Trends



KEY FINDINGS

WORKLOAD METRICS: KINEXON

Accumulated Acceleration Load

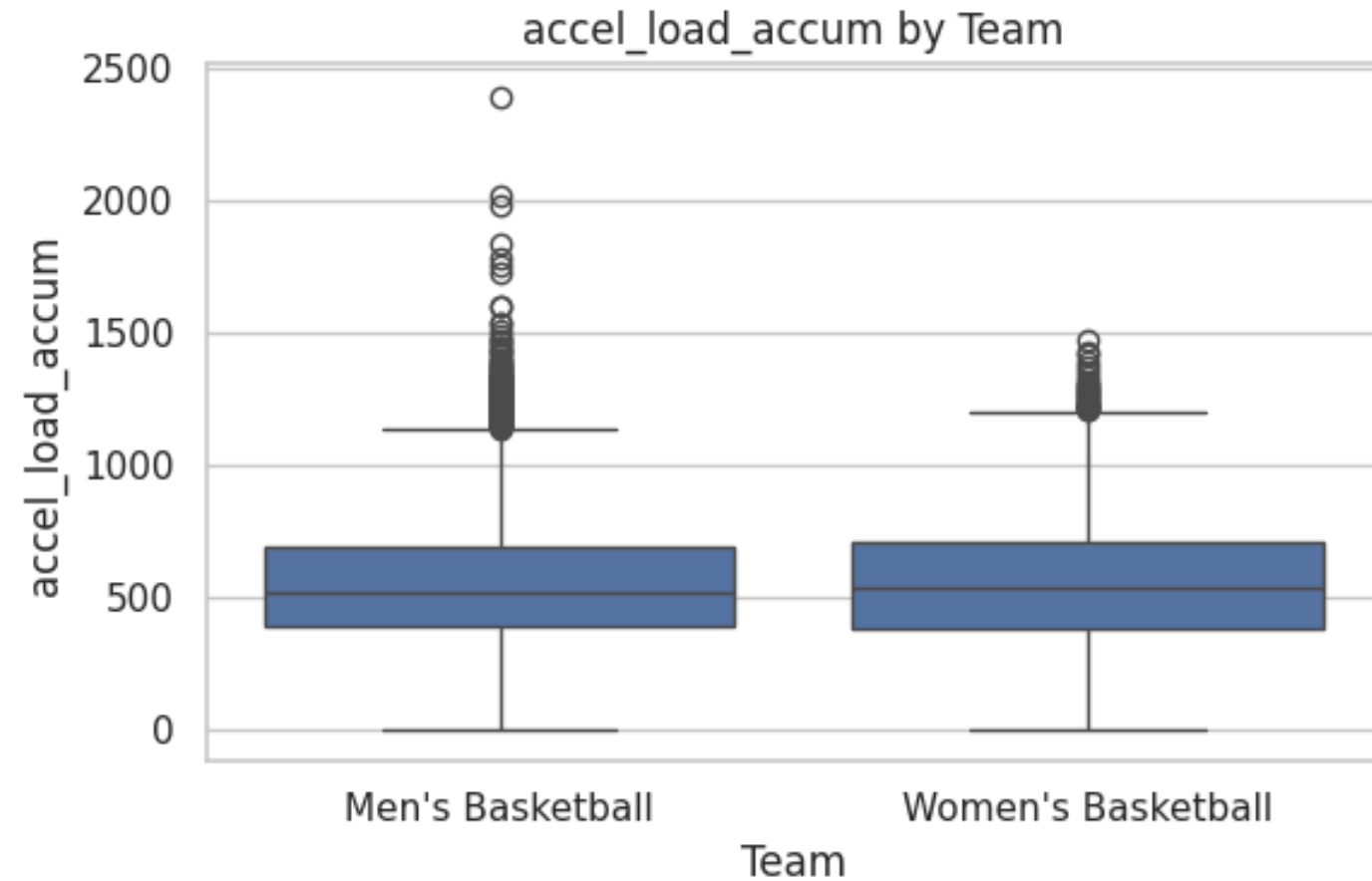
- Men: 9,224 samples
- Women: 8,395 samples
- $t = -2.84$, $p = .0045 \rightarrow$ Women slightly higher

Total Distance

- Men: 9,224
- Women: 8,395
- $t = 1.63$, $p = .104 \rightarrow$ No significant difference

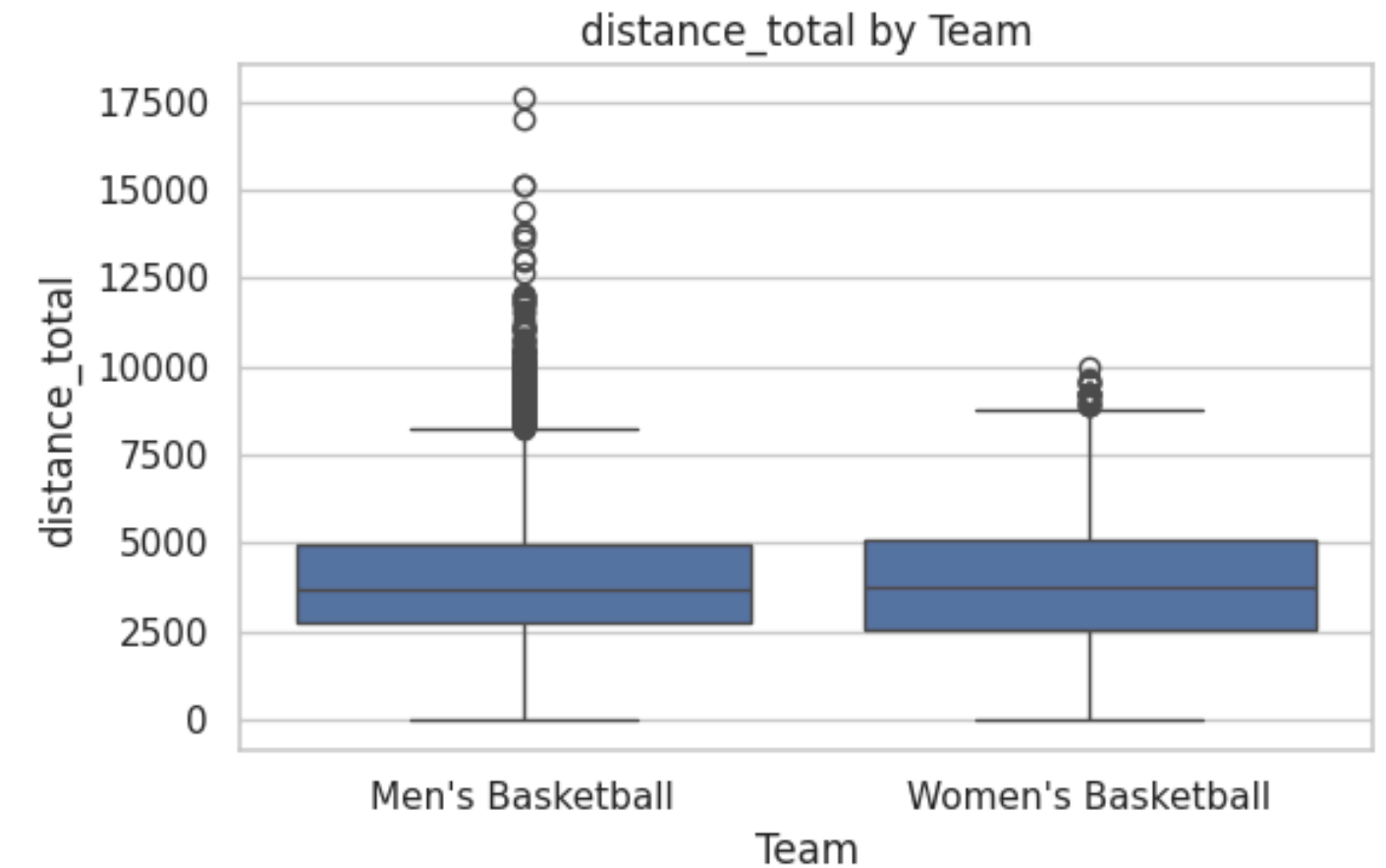
Generated Box Plots

Metric: accel_load_accum
Rows for this metric: 17619



Samples for Men's Basketball: 9224
Samples for Women's Basketball: 8395
t-statistic: -2.83537950764231
p-value : 0.004582353844008908

Metric: distance_total
Rows for this metric: 17619



Samples for Men's Basketball: 9224
Samples for Women's Basketball: 8395
t-statistic: 1.6259024101388189
p-value : 0.10398830414748231

JUMP PERFORMANCE METRICS: HAWKINS

Jump Height (m)

- Men: 920 samples
- Women: 613 samples
- $t = 34.77, p < 1e-190 \rightarrow$
Men higher

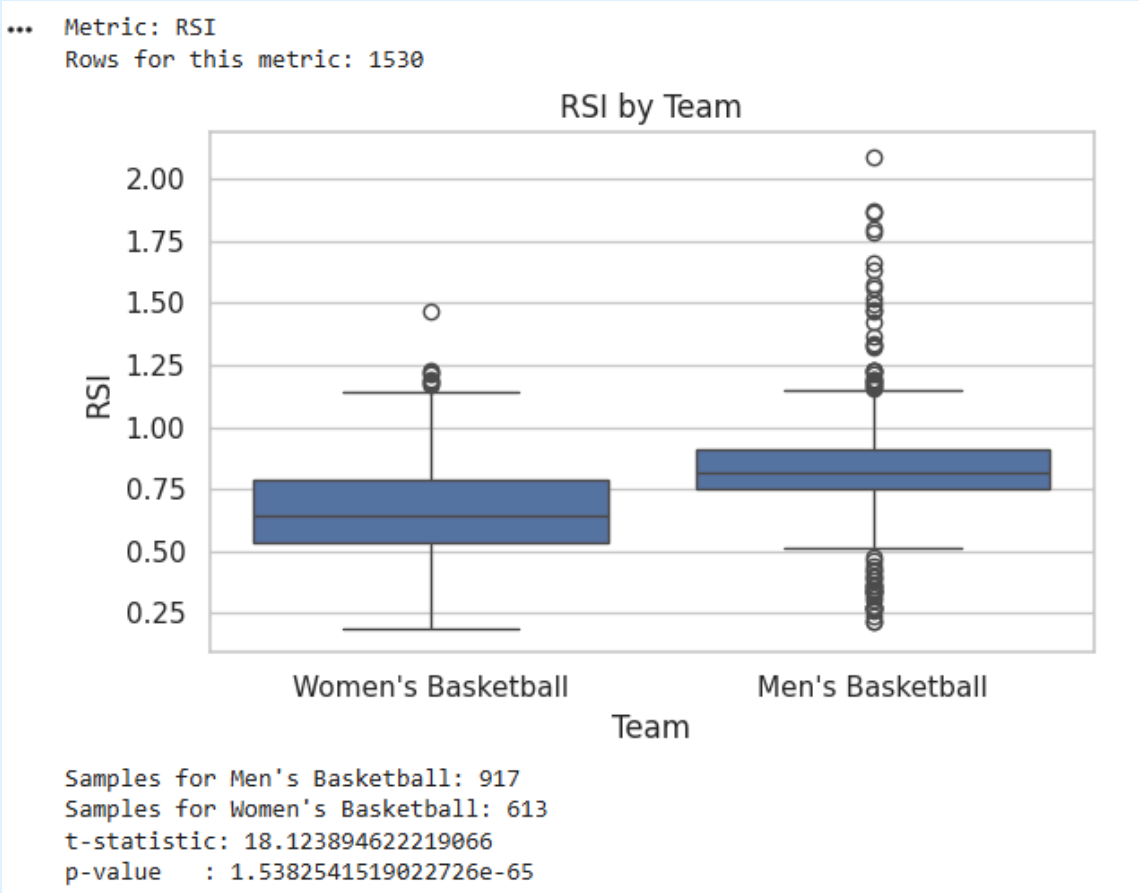
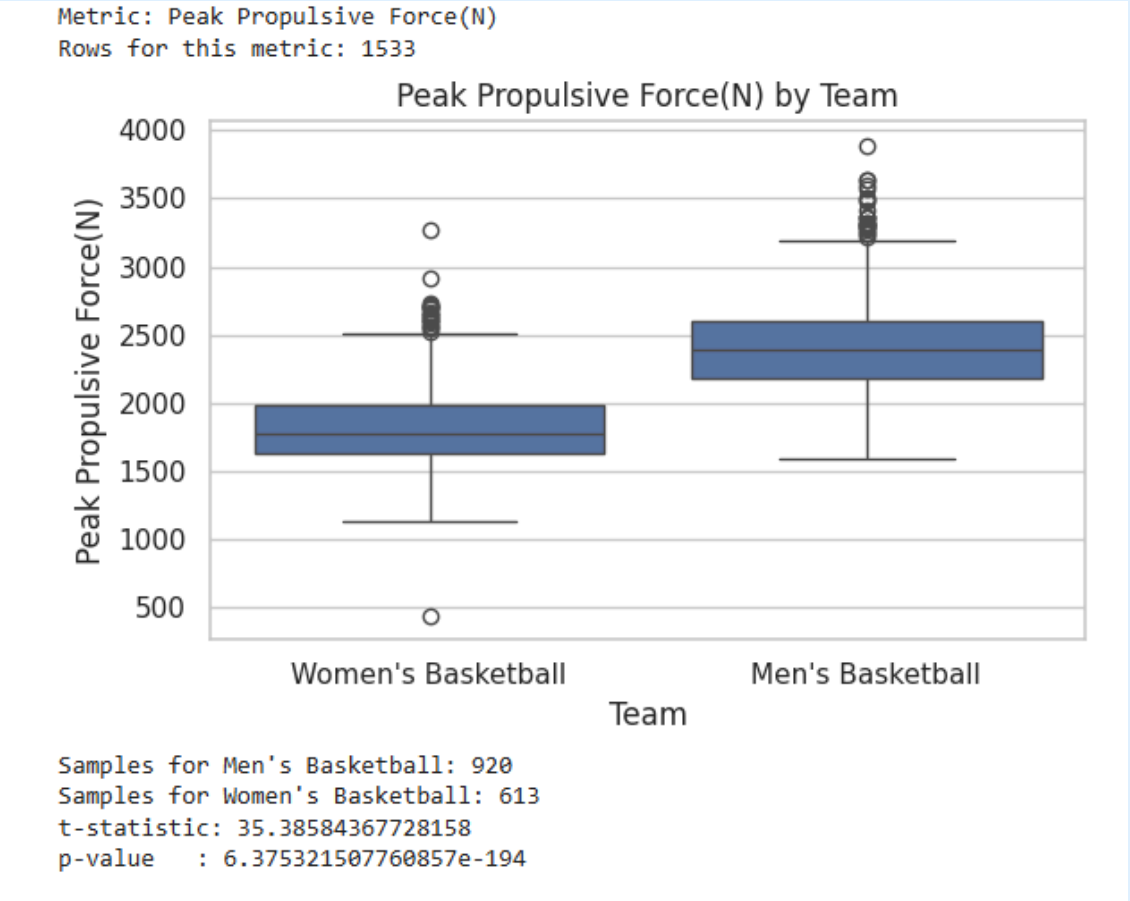
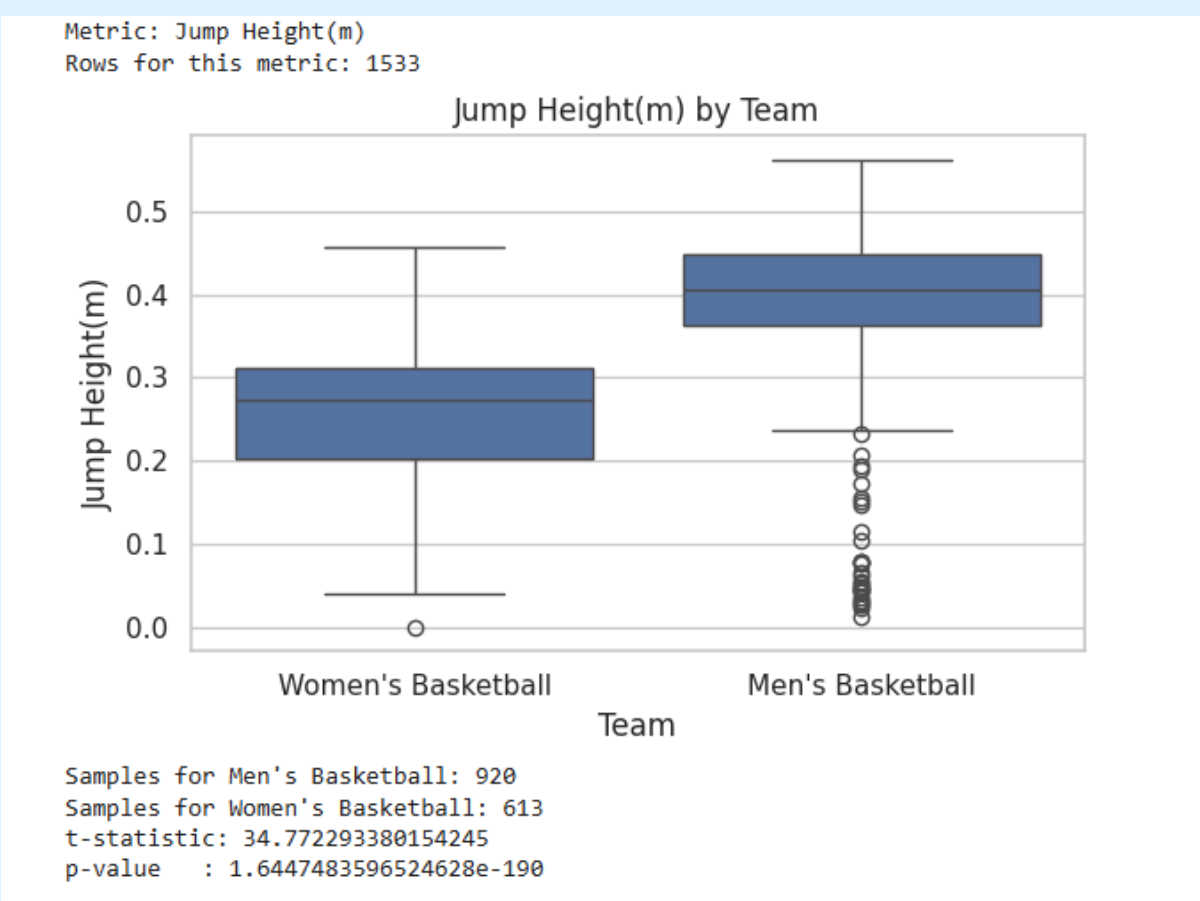
Peak Propulsive Force (N)

- Men: 920
- Women: 613
- $t = 35.39, p < 1e-193 \rightarrow$
Men higher

RSI

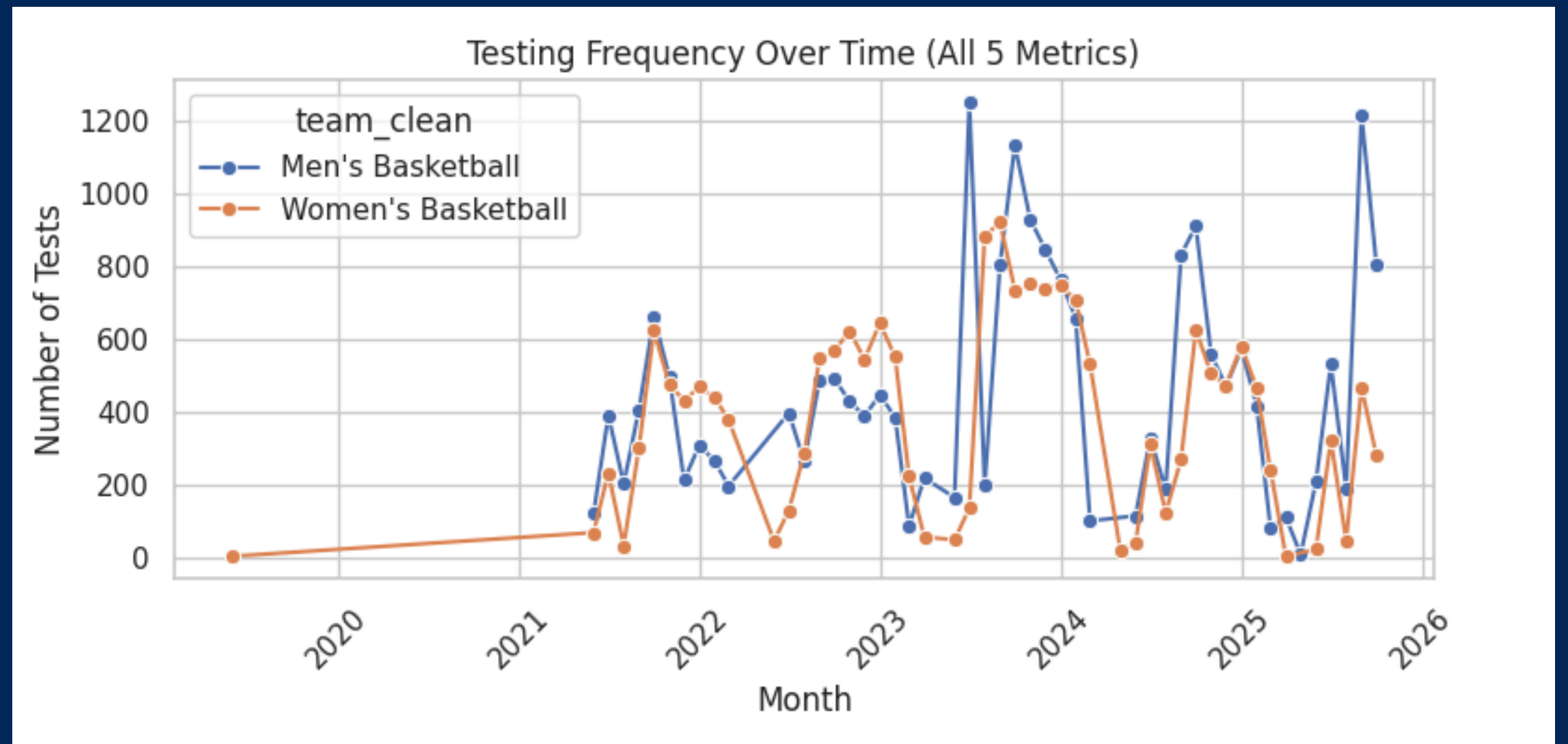
- Men: 917
- Women: 613
- $t = 18.12, p < 1e-65 \rightarrow$
Men higher

Generated Box Plots

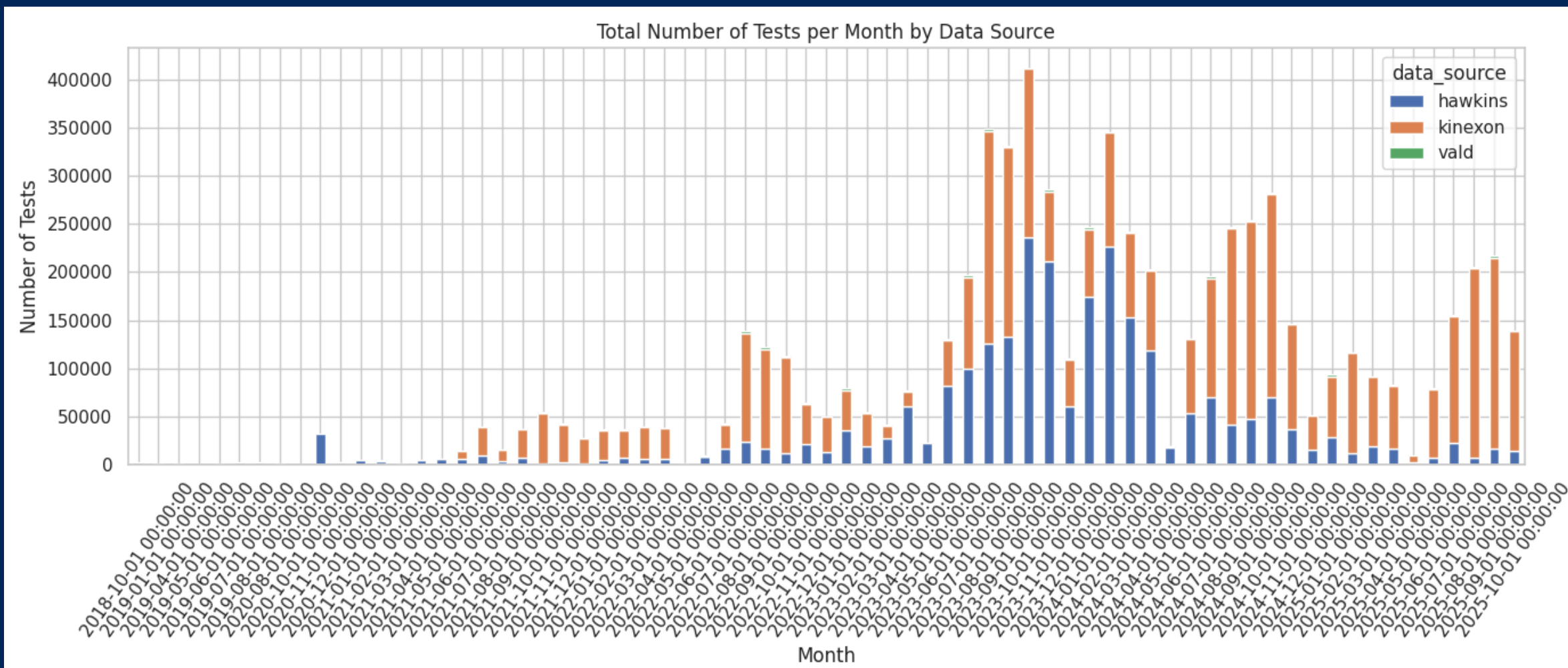


TESTING FREQUENCY OVER TIME

- Testing rises during the competitive season and drops during summer and winter breaks.
- Higher peaks for Women's Basketball
 - Higher WBB testing volume November 2021



OVERALL TRENDS ACROSS ALL DATA SOURCES



- Kinexon becomes dominant after 2022
 - Hawkins steady but lower volume
 - VALD minimal
 - Sharp increase in overall monitoring 2023–2024

JUMP METRICS:

Our Results vs. Published Norms

Men's team had much higher jump height, peak propulsive force, and RSI than women's

Differences were statistically huge (very small p-values)

Our jump heights, propulsive forces, and RSI values all fall inside published NCAA/elite ranges

This matches prior work showing men have greater lower-body power, muscle mass, and tendon stiffness and typically jump higher

WORKLOAD:

Accel Load & Distance vs Evidence

- **Total distance per session was not significantly different between men and women**

- **This fits prior work showing distance is a volume metric and often looks similar across roles/teams**

- Accumulated acceleration load was slightly higher in women (statistically significant, but small effect)
- This supports literature that accel-based metrics capture “hidden” high-intensity work (stop-go, changes of direction, impacts) that distance alone misses

HOW THE DATA FITS AND EXTENDS

With the Literature

Monitoring Patterns & Where We Add Value:

- Testing frequency follows NCAA seasons (more in pre-/in-season, dips in breaks)
- Use of Hawkins + Kinexon + VALD matches trends toward integrated monitoring
- Our data helps fill literature gaps:
 - Limited work on women's teams
 - Few studies combining jump metrics (CMJ, RSI) with load metrics (accel load, distance)
- Our analysis directly compares men vs. women and links performance + workload in one dataset

PRACTICAL APPLICATIONS

Performance Flagging System

- **CMJ Height / RSI:** Flag when values drop $\geq 10\%$ below rolling baseline.
- **AAL (Accumulated Acceleration Load):**
Flag when a session exceeds **150% of the athlete's rolling weekly average.**
- **Total Distance:** Flag when daily/session distance is **$< 80\%$ of team and position-specific norms.**

What This System Provides

- Detects neuromuscular fatigue, acute mechanical load spikes, and abnormal workload reductions.
- Gives practitioners a simple, individualized, and research-supported tool for monitoring readiness and recovery.

RECOMMENDATIONS FOR COACHES/TRAINERS

- Use $\geq 10\%$ CMJ/RSI drops as a cue to lower intensity or emphasize recovery strategies.
- Treat AAL spikes ($> 150\%$) as red-flag sessions that may require modified loading or additional recovery time.
- Investigate $< 80\%$ total distance days for signs of fatigue, limited engagement, or emerging injury.
- Integrate threshold checks into weekly planning to support consistent, objective decision-making.

ADDRESSING THE GAP

- Prior research often examines metrics individually, but readiness is multidimensional.
- Flagging system integrates neuromuscular, mechanical, and volume-based data into one practical framework.
- Provides a comprehensive, real-world monitoring model that helps staff identify performance issues earlier and more accurately than relying on any single measure.

LIMITATIONS & FUTURE WORK

Data Challenges

- Team names in the database were inconsistent and required cleaning before analysis.
- some metrics showed uneven availability across teams due to differences in equipmentment usage.
- Different data sources (Hawkins, Kinexon, Vald) had highly unequal test volumes.

Future Work

- improve consistency across teams and data sources
- increase testing frequency to strengthen trend detection

Q&A

As we continue refining our flagging system, do you recommend any specific statistical or coding approaches to validate whether our thresholds are too sensitive or not sensitive enough?